



THE ULTIMATE GUIDE TO
**BUYING
A HOME**

WITH HANNAH KEOWN, REALTOR®

Shop for Homes Online:

www.HannahKeownHomes.com

Call or Text:

270-589-8376



Dear hopeful homeowner—

You're taking the first step towards a huge life milestone: purchasing a home – *Congratulations!* This guide is your resource for each phase of home buying, including questions to ask yourself, worksheets, and checklists that will make this process as seamless as possible. Let's get started, shall we?!

What's INSIDE

→ **WHAT IT'S LIKE TO WORK WITH ME**

No pressure, no guesswork — just strategy, communication, and someone in your corner from start to keys.

→ **HONEST ANSWERS TO YOUR QUESTIONS**

From “how do you get paid?” to “do I have to sell first?” — I break it all down without the jargon.

→ **THE STEP-BY-STEP BUYER ROADMAP**

Because “we’ll figure it out as we go” is not a strategy.

→ **WHAT TO DO IF YOU'RE BUYING LATER**

1-2 years out? Perfect. Let's set you up with a plan so you're ahead of the game when the time comes.

→ **CHECKLISTS + TOOLS TO KEEP YOU ON TRACK**

From pre-approval to packing, I've got resources to help you stay organized and confident from start to close.

the FAQs

01 HOW DO YOU GET PAID?

As of 2024, buyer agent compensation is negotiable and can vary depending on the property and agreement with the seller. I'll walk you through what this looks like upfront so there are no surprises — and we'll discuss your options before we ever tour a home.

02 WHAT IF I'M NOT SURE IF I'M READY TO BUY?

Totally normal! I can help you explore what's possible, set up a custom search, and share resources to prepare — no pressure, just information to help you feel confident when the time is right.

03 HOW DO I KNOW WHAT I CAN AFFORD?

Start with a free mortgage pre-approval — I can connect you with trusted lenders who'll walk you through your numbers and help define your price range. I also include a simple home budget calculator in this guide!

04 WHAT IF I HAVE A HOUSE I NEED TO SELL FIRST?

No problem — I help clients buy and sell all the time. I'll walk you through timing, prep, and pricing so we can make a plan that feels smooth and stress-free. Whether you need to sell first, buy first, or do both at the same time, I've got you.

05 IS RIGHT NOW THE BEST TIME TO BUY?

The best time to buy is when it aligns with your goals. I'll help you understand what's happening in the Kentucky market and guide you through timing, strategy, and next steps based on your situation.

the ROADMAP



WHAT IT ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE TO BUY A HOME.

01

Let's talk goals

We'll chat about your timeline, must-haves, and what buying a home in Kentucky actually looks like right now — no pressure, just real talk.

02

Get pre-approved + set your budget

I'll connect you with a trusted lender to figure out your price range, monthly payments, and the best loan options for your situation.

03

Make it official

We'll review and sign a buyer agreement so I can fully represent you, advocate for your best interest, and start unlocking off-market opportunities.

04

Start your home search

You'll get a personalized VIP home search (and access to listings you might not find online). We'll tour the good ones and rule out the rest — no wasted weekends.

05

Make an offer + go under contract

Found the one? I'll walk you through the offer, negotiations, inspections, and all the fine print — with strategy at every step.

06

Close + celebrate

Once the paperwork is done and the keys are yours, we celebrate (and yes, I'll still be here if you need anything after closing).



PENNINGTON
PROPERTIES

STEP ONE

Choose Your Agent

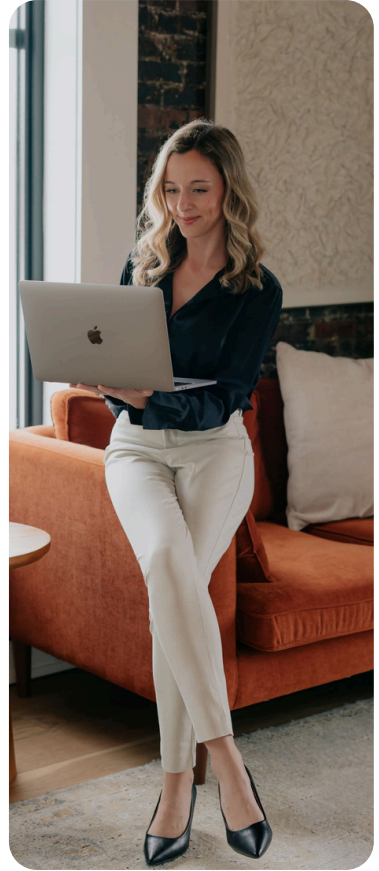
Choosing the real estate agent that you'll work alongside to buy your home is not a decision to take lightly.

Your agent should have a deep understanding of your goals, your market, and a track record for working diligently on behalf of you, their client.

Credentials, of course, are a plus- but what you can't see behind the numbers are the intangibles of always going the extra mile and genuinely caring deeply for clients.

I look forward to the opportunity of representing you and sharing this life milestone with you and your family.

Hannah Keown





Hannah Keown

REALTOR®

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www.HannahKeownHomes.com

[@HannahKeown_KYRealtor](https://www.instagram.com/HannahKeown_KYRealtor)

ABOUT ME

With over 9 years of real estate experience, I combine professional expertise with a personal, people-first approach. Whether you're relocating, buying your first home, or upgrading to your forever home, I bring both the knowledge and heart to make the process smooth and rewarding.

My commitment to growth and service has earned me several recognitions, including Media Awards, ERA Circle of Honor, and selection into the HKAR Leadership program. I believe that real estate should be equal parts business and relationship. I take time to truly understand my clients' needs, I never push, and always position myself as a guide—not a salesperson. My goal is to be a trusted resource from start to finish, making the experience stress-free and empowering.

CREDENTIALS

- A Certified Realtor
- 2023 Graduate of the Heart of Kentucky Association of Realtors Leadership Class
- Relocation Specialist
- Member of Greater Louisville Association of Realtors and Heart of Kentucky Association of Realtors

What you can expect working with me

I'm Curious

I want to have a clear understanding of your goals, who you are, and what your home means to you.

I'm Committed

I bring my A-game to every transaction, and I'm committed to achieving the best possible outcome for my clients.

I'm Proactive

I'm always one step ahead, anticipating potential roadblocks and finding creative solutions to overcome them.

I'm Personal

I believe in building relationships with my clients and treating them like family, because in the end, that's what leads to the best possible results.



The Value of a Buyer's Agent



Exclusive Representation for Your Interests

Unlike going through a listing agent who serves the seller's interests, a buyer's agent is committed solely to you. They ensure your needs and preferences are top priority, offering unbiased advice and support throughout the buying process.

Access to Off-Market Listings

Your buyer's agent can tap into a network that goes beyond the usual listings, including off-market or "pocket" listings. This access can be crucial in finding your dream home in competitive markets.

In-Depth Market Insight

Buyer's agents offer specialized knowledge of the local real estate market, from pricing trends to neighborhood dynamics. This insight is invaluable for making educated decisions and spotting hidden gems.

Skilled Negotiation on Your Behalf

Having a seasoned negotiator on your side can save you thousands. Buyer's agents negotiate not just on price, but on terms and conditions that best serve your interests.

Coordination of the Buying Process

From arranging viewings to coordinating inspections and navigating closing procedures, your agent handles the logistics. This coordination is essential for a smooth journey from house hunting to homeownership.

Insider Advice on Property Potential and Pitfalls

A buyer's agent looks beyond the surface, advising you on the potential or pitfalls of properties. They help you see the full picture, including aspects like future resale value and necessary repairs.

Exclusive Buyer Brokerage Agreement

Attached is the Exclusive Buyer Brokerage Agreement. As of August 17th, 2024, this document is required to be signed for a buyer's agent to show you homes and represent you in a real estate transaction. This agreement outlines our mutual responsibilities and ensures that you receive dedicated and professional service throughout your home-buying journey. Please review the document, and let me know if you have any questions or if you're ready to proceed.

As your buyer's agent, I will...

...negotiate for you

I'll secure the best price and terms, saving you money and stress.

...guide you through the market

With deep knowledge of local trends, I'll identify the right opportunities and neighborhoods for you.

...scout off-market properties

I'll scout off-market properties, giving you a competitive edge in finding your dream home.

...make it a seamless process

I'll handle every detail, from scheduling to paperwork, ensuring a smooth, hassle-free experience.



Hannah Keown

This isn't my *first* rodeo...

Buying or selling a home is a big deal — and I don't take it lightly. I've helped over 150 families make their move in Kentucky and I'm proud to say that most of my business comes from referrals and happy clients coming back for round two.



150+

HOMES SOLD

From cozy condos to move-in ready single family homes.

9+

YEARS IN BUSINESS

Grounded experience, local insight, and a people-first approach.

60%

BUYER REPRESENTATION

Helping clients from first-time home buyers to downsizers find the one.

100%

5-STAR REVIEWS

Strategic, proactive, and relentlessly focused on helping you find the one.

What Clients Are Saying

The experience with Hannah was awesome. Beyond Blessed to have Hannah as my Realtor. She was the best. Very understanding, communication was perfect she let us know every step of the way making the 30 days fly by. I would 100% recommend Hannah to be anyones realtor.

BAXTER FAMILY

was trying to find out where I stood on finding a home with a complicated financial and personal background after relocating to central KY. I spoke with a few diffrent agents that just didnt seem interested in helping. Then I met Hannah. Vibrant, connected, knowledgeable and enthusiast are some of the ways to describe her. Super loyal to her clients and agressive at getting the best for us. Not only did she dedicate her time to help me locate and purchase a better home than I was expecting; she made it fun for me and my son. She became a friend along the way. I am so thankful for all the help from Hannah and everyone from Jane Realty. I cant imagine using anyone else in the future. Thank you Hannah

BLEVINS FAMILIY

Hannah is out-going, takes initiative, and puts her clients first! We are military affiliated overseas and moving back to the States. Hannah has done an amazing job showing us houses virtually, answering our million questions, and going above and beyond! We felt supported throughout the entire process and she now feels like family!

MAIER FAMILY

STEP TWO

Considerations for Buyers



JOB & INCOME

Do you have a stable job and income? Are you staying in this line of work? What are your expenses, savings, and debts?

CREDIT SCORE

A credit score of 620 is typically required for conventional loans, while FHA has more flexibility depending on down payment.

DOWN PAYMENT

Depending on loan type, your down payment can range from 0%-20% of the purchase price.

CLOSING COSTS

Closing costs range from 2-6% of the loan amount. Other fees include inspection and appraisal costs.

LONG TERM PLANNING

Do you plan to stay in this location? Do you foresee major life changes? Consider how your career, family, and lifestyle might evolve over time.

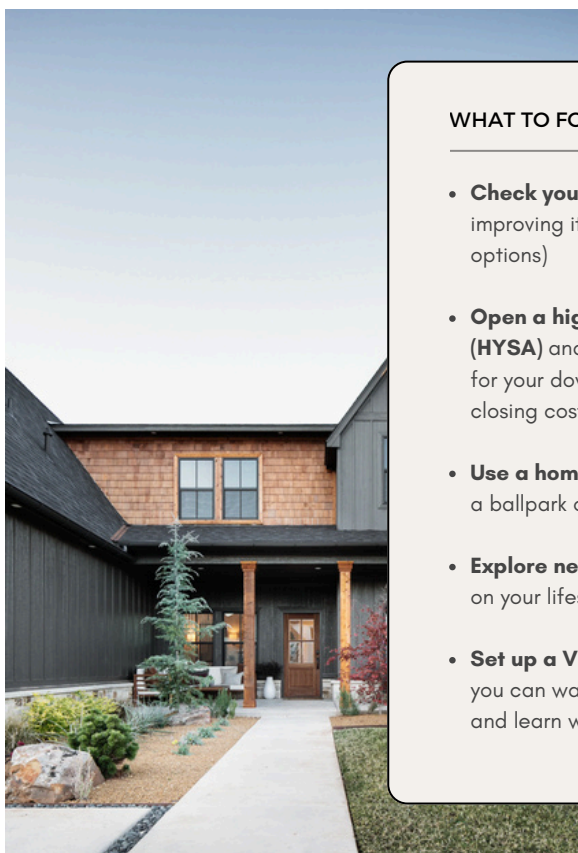
ONGOING COSTS

As a homeowner, your budget should factor in your monthly mortgage payments, property taxes, homeowner's insurance, & maintenance costs (roughly 1%-2% of purchase price per year). Ask your loan officer to include this cost into your monthly payment.

The “*Just Browsing*” Buyer Blueprint

1-2 YEARS OUT? PERFECT.

Buying later doesn’t mean you have to wait to get organized. In fact, this is the best time to lay the groundwork so when you’re ready, you’re not starting from scratch — you’re ready to move.



WHAT TO FOCUS ON NOW:

- **Check your credit score** and work on improving it (*ideally* 700+ for best loan options)
- **Open a high-yield savings account (HYSA)** and start putting aside money for your down payment (if needed), closing costs, and moving expenses
- **Use a home budget calculator** to get a ballpark of your budget
- **Explore neighborhoods** and get clear on your lifestyle must-haves
- **Set up a VIP Home Search** with me so you can watch the market in real time and learn what your money can get you

STEP THREE

The Mortgage Process



Let's talk finances

The next step of the home buying process is to understand how much you qualify for by meeting with a local lender and getting a pre-approval letter.

It's important to speak with a few lenders to find the right fit! Grab my lender interview questions on the next page. Plus, I've provided a few trusted lenders below so you can **fill out a loan application online!** It will only take 20 min of your time. Reach out to me if you have questions.

Remember that a pre-approval is only valid for 30-90 days, so while you can start reaching out to lenders, you'll want to secure that pre-approval letter closer to when you're ready to buy.

MY TRUSTED LENDER PARTNERS

Alex Turner |
812-461-8213

www.interlinecmortgage.com/alex-turner

Dennie Dowell |  Northpointe Bank
270-317-3283
www.Northpointe.com/homelending/getstarted/
Dennie-Dowell/

Kyle Turpin |  SUPREME LENDING
502-693-3145
www.kyleturpin.supremelendinglo.com

The Home Loan

HOW MUCH DO I NEED TO SAVE UP FOR A DOWN PAYMENT?

My lenders will try to approve you with 0% down. However, 3% is a good place to start. The average first time buyer puts down 7%. You can work with a mortgage lender to play around with numbers and see how your downpayment amount offsets your monthly payment, and especially with how PMI works.

HOW DO I KNOW IF I QUALIFY AND HOW MUCH I CAN AFFORD?

Contact a mortgage lender to get pre-approval for a loan. The lender will ask you some basic questions about your income and debts and can tell you what amount you can be approved for, and how much your mortgage payments will be.

WHAT DOES THE LENDER NEED FROM ME TO GIVE ME A LOAN?

Usually, you are asked to provide your last two tax returns to show proof of income. You should also provide recent bank and credit card statements and proof of your current pay. You will also be asked for your SSN so they can run a credit check.

WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN PRE-APPROVED AND PRE-QUALIFIED?

While often used interchangeably, these terms don't mean the same thing. Pre-qualification is an estimate of what you may be approved for based only on the verbal information you provide. Pre-approval means the lender has verified your income and debt information and run a credit check.

HOW DO I KNOW WHICH MORTGAGE OPTION IS RIGHT FOR ME?

Your mortgage lender is the best person to advise you on this question. Their products and qualifications change from time to time, so they would know best what products are available to meet your needs.

DO YOU HAVE A MORTGAGE LENDER I CAN TALK TO?

Yes, absolutely! I have a few that I work with that I can happily refer to you. Just ask and I'll connect you. You are welcome to use your own if you have someone in mind as well.

WHEN SHOULD I GET PRE-APPROVED?

About 3-6 months out from when you'd like to move. If that has already passed, no worries! Pre-approvals only take about 2-3 days, you just want to have that pre-approval before you begin shopping.

Lender Questionnaire

NAME: _____ COMPANY: _____

PHONE: _____ EMAIL: _____

What type of loan do you recommend for me and why?

Do I qualify for down payment assistance programs?

What is the interest rate? What is the APR?

Will I pay mortgage insurance?

What will my monthly payment be?

Can I lock in an interest rate? If so for how long? Are there fees associated?

What will my closing costs be? Are they a part of my loan, or will I pay them at closing?

STEP FOUR

Wants vs. Needs



Before we hop into the home search, I advise my clients to create a "Needs" list and a "Wants" list. This will help us to focus on the things that are most important in your future home.

NEEDS MIGHT LOOK LIKE

- ✓ Enough bedrooms for your family
- ✓ First floor master bedroom
- ✓ Close proximity to work or school
- ✓ Attached two-car garage
- ✓ Yard for children or pets

NEEDS

"Needs" are the non-negotiable features. "Wants" are the nice-to-haves, but you can live without or add down the road. Remember you can't change the lot, the location, or the price you paid.

WANTS MIGHT LOOK LIKE

- ✓ Specific paint or exterior color
- ✓ Fenced-in backyard
- ✓ Specific flooring
- ✓ Kitchen amenities or appliances
- ✓ Walk-in shower or double vanity

WANTS

STEP FIVE

The Home Search Process



FIRST THINGS FIRST

Now that you've got your "Wants vs. Needs" list in hand, the fun really begins! I will set you up on a search so you'll receive an email *the minute* a property that fits your criteria hits the market.

WANT TO DO SOME ONLINE SEARCHING YOURSELF?

- **Use the search filters, but don't go crazy.** Expand your geographic search, and add \$5k - \$12k to your max price.
- **Check Google Street View** if you find something that catches your eye. And if you're local, drive by the property.
- **If a home you like is "pending" or "under contract" don't panic!** Pending contracts fall through occasionally so keep it on your list, especially if it checks all your boxes.
- **Jot down the MLS number & address.** Send this information to me and I will call the listing agent to gather pertinent info.

The Home Search

WHAT SHOULD I DO WHEN I SEE A HOUSE ONLINE THAT I LIKE?

Text me, your buyer's agent: the agent you are working with to find your home. It's best that you work with one real estate agent throughout your search. That agent learns what you like and dislike and will invest a lot of time vetting properties for you. That person also represents your best interests only. When you call the agent advertising the home, you are dealing with the seller's agent, so, while they can assist you, they are also representing the seller's best interest.

CAN YOU SHOW ME A HOUSE IF IT'S NOT YOUR LISTING?

Absolutely. As a buyer's agent, I can show you *any* house listed, and I will contact FSBO sellers on your behalf. As mentioned above, working with me as your buyer's agent ensures that your best interests are protected.

HOW DO WE WRITE AN OFFER?

When you find the property you want to make an offer on, I will run a Comparative Market Analysis (CMA) to help you determine a fair offer amount. I will also guide you through the additional terms of the contract, such as the escrow amount, closing date, and any additional terms you want to be added to the offer. I will write the offer on a contract form and submit it to the seller's agent.

WHAT IF I WANT TO BACK OUT OF A CONTRACT?

Once you are under contract, **there is no rescision period**. When the contract is contingent on a property inspection, you usually have the right to cancel for major required repairs during the inspection period. Once the inspection period has passed, you cannot back out and keep your deposit unless the seller agrees, or an additional term has not been met.

WHAT HAPPENS IF THERE ARE OTHER OFFERS ON THE HOUSE I LOVE?

If a seller receives multiple offers on their home, usually their agent will inform the buyer's that multiple offers have been received and the buyers have another opportunity to alter their original offer to present their "best and final" offer. Keep in mind that many factors may influence the seller in addition to the offer price, such as the down payment amount, closing date, and inspection terms.

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN MY OFFER GETS ACCEPTED?

Once both parties have agreed on all terms and signed the contract, your escrow deposit must be made and I schedule the home inspection. Your lender will receive a copy of the contract and will begin processing your mortgage application.

STEP SIX

Showings

MY BEST SHOWING TIPS

✓ **Read over your Wants vs. Needs list and revisit your budget.** Having this fresh on your mind will help you stay objective and focused.

✓ **Utilize Google Street View.** This is a great way to take a virtual walk around the neighborhood.

✓ **Take pictures and videos.** This will help you to jog your memory later.

✓ **Consider the lot, lot size, and location.** All of these things can't be changed.

✓ **Look past decor & staging.** These things will soon be gone.

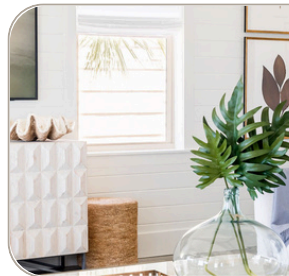
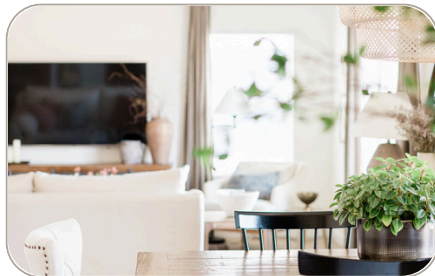
KEEP AN EYE OUT FOR

✓ **Structural integrity**
Look for signs of structural integrity. Water damage, cracks in walls or ceilings, sloping floors.

✓ **Noise levels**
From nearby roads, businesses, airports and railways.

✓ **Roof & water damage**
Check for leaks near plumbing sources, water stains on the ceiling, or damage to siding, windows, and doors.

✓ **Layout and flow**
Does the property's layout suit your lifestyle? Would it require renovations? Check room sizes, storage, and flow between rooms.



Showing Checklist

ADDRESS

EXTERIOR RATING (1-10)

INTERIOR RATING (1-10)

LIST 3 PROS OF THE HOME:

LIST 3 CONS OF THE HOME:

TOOK VIDEOS / PHOTOS

INITIAL REACTION (CIRCLE)

☐

YES

☐

NO

NO

MAYBE

VERY INTERESTED

IT'S THE ONE!

ADDRESS

EXTERIOR RATING (1-10)

INTERIOR RATING (1-10)

LIST 3 PROS OF THE HOME:

LIST 3 CONS OF THE HOME:

TOOK VIDEOS / PHOTOS

INITIAL REACTION (CIRCLE)

☐

YES

☐

NO

NO

MAYBE

VERY INTERESTED

IT'S THE ONE!

STEP SEVEN

Writing your Offer



So you think you've found "the one" and you're ready to put in an offer. Woohoo!

Let's talk about making an offer **that truly stands out**. Below are my tried and tested recommendations.

WRITING A COMPELLING OFFER

We'll include your pre-approval letter. This letter shows that you're serious, qualified, and ready to purchase.

We'll gather information about what the seller is looking for. Understanding their needs and motivations will be a big part of writing a great offer.

We'll put your best foot—and price—forward. In a competitive market, you may only get one shot, so we will make it count! We'll use comps and trends as a guide.

We'll propose to close quickly. Offering a shorter closing timeline will signal to the seller we have a serious offer and we're ready to move fast.

UNDERSTANDING THE TERMS OF YOUR OFFER

Purchase price

This is the amount you're offering to pay for the home. It's often negotiable, especially if there are multiple offers, the home needs repairs, or if the home has been on the market for a while.

Earnest money deposit

This is a good faith deposit showing your serious intent to buy. It's typically 1-3% of the purchase price and is held in escrow. If the sale goes through, the deposit is applied to your down payment or closing costs. If you back out without a valid contingency, you might forfeit the deposit.

Inspection period

Most buyers include a home inspection contingency, allowing time (usually 7-10 days) to hire an inspector to check the home's condition. If major issues are found, we can negotiate repairs or back out of the deal.

Contingencies

A contingency is a condition that must be met before a buyer and seller can finalize the purchase of a home.

A financing contingency protects you in the case that you are not able to secure a mortgage. If your loan falls through, you can back out without penalty. An appraisal contingency ensures the home appraises for at least the amount of your offer. If it doesn't, you can renegotiate or walk away. An inspection contingency allows you to renegotiate or cancel the offer if the home inspection reveals significant issues.

Closing costs

These include lender fees, title insurance, taxes, and other costs associated with finalizing the sale. Closing costs can range from 2-5% of the purchase price.

Closing date

This is the date you and the seller agree to finalize the transaction and transfer ownership. This is usually 30-45 days from when the offer is accepted but can vary based on financing or other factors. We will ask for the keys at closing!

STEP EIGHT

We're Under Contract!

Your offer has been accepted — cue the confetti! And while it will be a few more days until you can move in, you're well on your way to closing the deal on your new home. Here's a quick rundown on what happens once your new home is "under contract."

01

Provide Escrow Deposit

This deposit shows your commitment to buying the property. It is typically held in the buyers brokers escrow account until closing.

02

Schedule Inspection

Depending on the results, your agent may negotiate with the seller for repairs or credits. Schedule this immediately!

03

Finalize Loan Application

Submit your formal mortgage application.

04

Secure Insurance

You'll need homeowners insurance in place before closing. Your lender may require proof to finalize the loan.

05

Order Appraisal

Your lender will initiate this to ensure the property's value matches the sale price. If it comes in lower, we'll go back to negotiations! If it comes in more, you will have instant equity!

06

Title Search

A title company will conduct a title search to ensure there are no liens against the property. You'll also purchase title insurance to protect against unforeseen title problems.

07

Final Walkthrough

Before the closing date, you'll do a final walk-through of the property to ensure it's in the agreed-upon condition.

08

Closing Day

Sign documents, pay remaining closing costs and down payment. The title is transferred to you and the keys are exchanged!

Under Contract

WHAT DOES "UNDER CONTRACT" MEAN?

Under contract means that all parties have agreed on terms, have signed the contract, and the signed contract has been delivered to both buyer and seller. The escrow money will need to be deposited within 3 days of accepted contract.

WHAT IS EMD?

The earnest money deposit is money that is offered with an offer, or as soon as an offer is accepted, to show the seller that you are serious about moving forward with the purchase of the home. Because you forfeit this deposit if you back out of the purchase for any reason not allowed for in the contract, the larger the escrow deposit, the more seriously your offer is taken. This deposit is part of your downpayment, not in addition to.

DO I NEED AN INSPECTION?

I always recommend that you have a home inspection done. In the scheme of things, paying a few hundred dollars to have peace of mind that there are no hidden dangers or problems is well worth the money.

HOW MUCH ARE INSPECTIONS?

The cost of the home inspection depends on the size of the house and additional inspections requested, such as swimming pool, septic tank, termites, insurance four-point (HVAC, plumbing, roof, and electrical,) and radon. An average home inspection, without additional inspections, is about \$350-\$600.

WHAT IF MY LOAN DOESN'T GET APPROVED?

If you have gone through the pre-approval process and have been forthcoming with all the information requested by your lender, it's unlikely you will be turned down. Make sure you do not change jobs, purchase big-ticket items on credit, take out a car or boat loan, or open any other new credit accounts while your mortgage is being processed. Please remember: **NO BIG SPENDING WHILE PENDING!**

WHEN CAN I START MOVING?

When you have the keys! When you are financing your purchase, it takes about 3-4 weeks for your loan to be processed. Once the lender gives the all-clear, closing is scheduled. You will sign your loan documents and both parties will sign documents transferring ownership to you. Unless other arrangements have been agreed upon by both parties, the sellers should have completely vacated the home when they sign the closing papers. You can have your belongings ready to move, and a moving company scheduled before you go to closing.

Under Contract Checklist

Send Escrow Deposit

Escrow deposit amount: _____

Escrow deposit recipient: _____

Be very careful when wiring funds.
Never trust wiring instructions sent via email.

Begin Loan Application

Start your loan application within 1 day from the executed contract date.

During your loan processing, it is VERY IMPORTANT not to make any major job changes, major purchases, or open new credit cards, as any of these activities could alter your qualifications.

Schedule Inspections

The last day to renegotiate or cancel the contract due to issues revealed by the inspections is: _____

Obtain Home Insurance

Contact insurance companies for quotes before the end of the inspection period.

Important Dates

EXECUTED CONTRACT DATE

ESCROW DEPOSIT DUE

LOAN APPLICATION DUE

INSPECTION PERIOD ENDS

ESTIMATED CLOSING DAY

HOME ADDRESS	TITLE COMPANY	PURCHASE PRICE	ESCROW DEPOSIT
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____		
_____	_____		

STEP NINE

Inspections & Insurance



WHAT'S A HOME INSPECTION?

The inspection will uncover any issues in the home that would have otherwise been unknown. You will receive a written report of the inspection. I recommend that you are present for the inspection, so that you may ask any questions.

WHAT IS THE INSPECTION PERIOD?

Typically, inspection periods can last anywhere from 7 to 10 days. During this time, the buyer has the right to hire a professional to inspect the condition of the home.

THE INSPECTION REVEALED ISSUES...

Inspections do not get a PASS or FAIL. If the inspection reveals any issues, the buyer may ask the seller to cover the costs of repairs or ask for a seller credit. The buyer has the right to back out and get their escrow deposit back.

DO I REALLY NEED AN INSPECTION?

The home may appear to be in perfect shape, but some of the costliest problems are difficult to spot: leaks, termite damage, foundation issues, poor ventilation, faulty wiring, and leaking appliances.

WHEN SHOULD I SCHEDULE IT?

Schedule all inspections immediately, so if we need to negotiate any repairs we can *before* the inspection period ends.

WHAT ABOUT HOME INSURANCE?

Once you have a signed contract, start looking for insurance providers immediately. Your lender will typically require evidence of insurance coverage before they approve your mortgage. Gather multiple quotes!

Inspections Cheat Sheet

INSPECTION TYPE	DESCRIPTION	AVERAGE COST
STANDARD	The standard home inspector's report will cover the condition of the home's heating system; central air conditioning system; interior plumbing and electrical systems; the roof, attic and visible insulations; walls, ceilings, floors, windows and doors; the foundation, basement and structural components.	\$500.00
FOUR-POINT	The Four-Point Inspection examines 4 main things: Electrical, HVAC, Roof & Structure, and Plumbing. The Four-Point will most likely be required by your homeowner's insurance if the home is more than 30 years old.	\$350
WDO	The WDO Inspection is the Wood-Destroying Organism Inspection. Ask your lender if your loan requires any certain inspections such as a WDO inspection.	\$75
LEAD-BASED PAINT	If the home was built prior to 1978, a lead-based paint inspection is recommended	VARIES

Trusted Inspection Companies

ABOVE & BEYOND HOME INSEPTIONS

Jay Vair
270-317-2717

KNOW BEFORE YOU BUY

Tim Mattingly
502-759-6355

BEST VALUE HOME INSEPTION

Paul Wells
270-268-0389

Home Insurance Cheat Sheet

INSURANCE TYPE	DESCRIPTION
HOMEOWNERS	The standard homeowners insurance covers financial protection against loss due to disasters, theft and accidents.
HAZARD	Hazard insurance protects against damage caused by fires, severe storms, hail/sleet, or other natural events.
FLOOD	Flood insurance protects against damage caused by a flood.
WINDSTORM	Wind insurance protects against damage caused by tornadoes, hurricanes, or gales.

Trusted Insurance Companies

HOOVER MAJORS INSURANCE

Dani Saltzman
270-259-6141
danie@hoovermajors.com

CARTER HARRELL STATE FARM

Daniel Mudd
270-259-0327

SHELTER INSURANCE

Donna Vanmeter
270-259-4488
dvanmeter@shelterinsurance.com

Pre-Closing Checklist

**BRAVO! HERE'S WHAT YOU'VE
COMPLETED SO FAR:**

- ☒ **Under contract**
- ☒ **Inspections**
- ☒ **Obtain home insurance**

**THE CLOSING TABLE IS NEAR!
HERE'S WHAT'S NEXT:**

Order Appraisal

An appraisal is an estimate of the value of the property by a licensed professional appraiser. Once problems are resolved from inspection, the lender will order an appraisal and paid for by you. The appraisal verifies the value of the property for the lender and to protect you from overpaying.

The contract is contingent upon whether the appraisal comes in at or above the purchase price. If the appraisal comes back low, it's back to negotiations!

Obtain Mortgage

You have 1 day from the date of contract execution to begin the mortgage loan application. During the 30-45 days before closing, your lender will be finalizing the loan.

Conduct Survey

Unless a recent survey of the property exists, a recent one may be requested. The survey is a sketch showing a map of the property lines and boundaries and reveals if there are any encroachments on the property. The survey is ordered by the title company and paid for by the buyer.

TIP

It is very important not to make any major job changes, purchases, or open new credit cards, as any of these activities could alter your qualifications for a loan.

Title Search

The title company will conduct a title search to ensure the property is legitimate and that there are no outstanding mortgage liens, judgments, easements, leases, unpaid taxes, or other restrictions that would impact your ownership.

Once the title is found to be valid, the title company will issue a title insurance policy which protects lenders or owners against claims or legal fees that may arise over ownership of the property. This will be included in closing costs.

Clear to Close

The magic words! This phrase means the mortgage underwriter has officially approved all documentation required to fund the loan. All that remains is the actual closing process.

STEP TEN

Closing Time!

We've completed all the pre-closing steps. High five! Here's a quick rundown on what you can expect from the closing process and closing day.

Loan Approval

After the appraisal and inspection, your lender will finalize your loan. You'll hear the magic words "Clear to close!"

Review Closing Disclosure

You will receive a closing disclosure from your lender at least three days before closing. It outlines the final terms of your loan, including the interest rate, loan amount, and closing costs. Review it carefully - this will tell you the funds to bring on closing day.

Arrange Utilities Transfer

Contact utility providers to set up services like electricity, gas, water, and internet for the day of closing or move-in day. They may require "Proof of Ownership." In that case, bring your closing disclosure when setting them up.

Obtain Certified Funds

You'll need to bring certified funds (cashier's check or wire transfer) for your down payment and closing costs. Your closing agent will provide you with the exact amount a few days before closing.



Down Payment Costs

This is the amount you are contributing toward the purchase price. The exact amount depends on your loan type (often between 3% and 20%). Although there are programs that will cover your down payment if you qualify.

Closing Costs

THESE ARE FEES ASSOCIATED WITH OBTAINING YOUR MORTGAGE

- **Loan Origination Fees:** Charged by the lender for processing your mortgage application - typically 0.5%-1% of the loan amount.
- **Discount Points:** These are optional fees paid to lower your interest rate.
- **Appraisal Fee:** This typically costs around \$500-\$700.
- **Credit Report Fee:** The lender charges this for checking your credit, typically \$25-\$50.
- **Underwriting Fee:** Lender charges for evaluating your loan, typically \$400-\$1,000.
- **Title Search Fee:** The cost of a title company researching the property's history to ensure there are no liens or claims - usually \$150-\$400.
- **Title Insurance:** Protects you and your lender against future claims on the property's title - usually 0.5%-1% of the purchase price.
- **Escrow/Settlement Fee:** Paid to the title company or attorney handling the closing - usually \$500-\$1,000.

Prepays

THESE ARE UPFRONT PAYMENTS FOR FUTURE EXPENSES RELATED TO YOUR PROPERTY

- **Homeowner's Insurance Premium:** You typically pay the first year's premium upfront
- **Property Taxes:** Lenders may require 2-3 months of property taxes to be pre-paid into an escrow account. This ensures funds are available when the tax bill is due.
- **Prepaid Interest:** Interest that accrues on your loan from the closing date until the first mortgage payment, based on the closing date and loan terms.
- **Private Mortgage Insurance (PMI):** If your down payment is less than 20%, you may need to pay upfront mortgage insurance premiums.

Total Expected Cash to Bring

- On average, closing costs range from **2%-5% of the purchase price of the home**. This includes loan costs, pre-pays, and title fees.
- You will receive a **closing disclosure** from your lender at least three days before closing, detailing the exact amount of cash you need to bring.
- Use a certified check or wire transfer for the funds, as **personal checks are typically not accepted at closing**.

Vocab to Know

ACTIVE

The property is actively for sale and on the market. The sellers may have received offers but have not accepted any yet.

ADJUSTABLE-RATE MORTGAGE (ARM)

After an introductory period that could be 3, 5, 7 or 10 years, the interest rate on an adjustable-rate mortgage will be adjusted by the lender by current interest rates.

BACK ON MARKET

This property was under contract with another buyer and their contract fell through, so it is active again.

CLOSING COSTS

The fees that the buyer and seller will owe associated with the home-buying process, such as the real estate brokerage commission and title insurance. Most are paid by the buyer, but the seller pays for some. We can try to negotiate who pays in the offer.

CONTINGENCY

A provision of the contract that keeps the agreement from being fully legally binding until a certain condition is met. For example, the purchase of a home can be contingent upon the buyer selling their home first.

DOWN PAYMENT

The sum in cash that you can afford to pay at the time of purchase. A conventional loan down payment is usually between 5%-20% of the sales price, but other types of financing require as little as 0%-3.5%. A mortgage lender can tell you what types of loans you qualify for.

EXPIRED

A listing has expired and is no longer active, usually because it didn't sell in the amount of time agreed upon by the listing agent and the owner of the home. If you see an Expired listing, the owner may still be interested in selling.

FIXED-RATE MORTGAGE

This mortgage's interest rate will never change, even if the term of the loan is 30 years.

FSBO

For Sale by Owner. Often pronounced "fisbo" The owner of the home has it listed without an agent representation. A Buyer's agent can usually still show the home, as many FSBOs will agree to work agents representing a buyer.

INTEREST

A percentage of the principal that you borrowed from the bank. The rate can fluctuate daily.

MLS

The Multiple Listing Service. The MLS is used to search for and list properties. They collect, compile and distribute all information about homes listed for sale. Membership isn't open to the general public, although selected MLS data may be sold to real estate listing websites.

PENDING

The property owner has accepted an offer and are under contract with a buyer. Their agreement may be contingent upon a variety of contingencies: inspections, appraisal, financing, and more. The home is not sold just yet.



PART TWO

Congratulations, New Homeowner!

Resources to help you with the move and
settling into your new home.

Next Steps

LET'S MAKE A GAME PLAN

Whether you're ready to start touring homes or just getting your finances in order, here's how we can work together:

1. We'll book a quick intro call to talk timing, goals, and next steps.
2. I'll set up your custom VIP Home Search.
3. I'll send over prep tools based on where you are in the buying process.
4. We'll go at your pace — whether that means looking now or prepping for later.

SCHEDULE A 30 MIN CALL

Your next move starts here — and
I'll guide you the whole way.



Hannah Keown

270-589-8376

HANNAHKEOWNHOMES@GMAIL.COM

WWW.HANNAHKEOWNHOMES.COM



THANK YOU

Thank you for trusting me with your home search. I'm here for any questions or concerns you have about your new home. If you're satisfied with my service, reviews and referrals are greatly appreciated.

Hannah Keown

Please help my business grow!



WRITE A REVIEW



FOLLOW ALONG

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